

The club's vision and why was club established:

Back in 2022, a group of curious minds at MIST from the CSE Department, saw something most people had not yet noticed. Cybersecurity in Bangladesh was still an almost untouched frontier. Emon and his batchmates realized that while the digital world was growing fast, most students had little access to structured learning or guidance in this vital field. The resources that did exist were scattered and hard to follow, leaving aspiring learners to piece things together on their own. They decided to change that.

That is how the MIST Cybersecurity Club was born with a clear mission to give people the knowledge, skills, and tools to protect their digital world. The founders believed that cybersecurity is not just about coding and hacking, but also a part of everyday life that everyone should understand. The club quickly became a home for students eager to explore the world of digital defense. From hands-on workshops to exciting competitions, members started building real skills while connecting with experts and with each other.

Today, the club is more than just a student organization. It is a growing community that is inspiring the next wave of innovators in Bangladesh's cybersecurity space. And it all started with a few students who decided not to wait for change, but to build it themselves.

How MCSC is shaping Bangladesh's cybersecurity scene in the present times:

- **Hands-on learning, not just theory:** Students train on the MIST Cyber Range. They experience simulated real-world attacks and defenses, which helps them build job-ready skills quickly.
- **Organizing multiple intra and inter-university contests:** From the flagship LeetCon to events like Flaghunt, Cyber Raid, and inter-university CTFs, MCSC brings students, professionals, and agencies together. This spreads awareness and raises the national skill level.
- **Clear career guidelines and mentorships from qualified seniors and alumni:** Courses and challenges, including CTFs and workshops, create a clear path from beginner to practitioner. These efforts feed talent into SOCs, banks, and tech teams. Moreover, the constant support from senior club members and to a larger scale, from former members and alumni, sets the caliber of this club to a whole new degree.
- **An ever-rising community:** Regular challenges, meetups, and mentoring build a culture of curiosity, teamwork, and continuous improvement.
- **Real problems, real challenges, real solutions:** The club focuses on practical topics like web security, forensics, reverse engineering, and threat hunting. This enables members to contribute to securing organizations right away.

Bottom line, MCSC turns interest into impact that scales to a magnitude beyond comparison for many. It trains confident learners, curious souls and constantly growing talents, connects the community, and strengthens Bangladesh's cybersecurity readiness.

The beginning:

Since its early days, the club has been active in hosting impactful events. The journey gained momentum with MIST LeetCon 2023: HackMelfYouCan. This major national competition and workshop was held in collaboration with the ICT Division, Bangladesh Computer Council and Digital Security Agency. It was followed by Flag Hunt 2023, a nationwide CTF competition and the FI and Critical Information Infrastructure Cyber Drill, which trained cyber analysts from around 30 of the country's leading banks. The club has also organised MIST CyberTron, Cyber Camp 0.1, Hacker Camp 0.1, and Talent Hunt. Each event aimed at strengthening technical expertise and inspiring early participation. In May 2025, the club co-hosted a national hackathon for World Telecommunication and Information Society Day, where 190 teams competed online and 35 reached the onsite finals. Participants solved challenges in cryptography, web, forensics, networking, steganography, and reverse engineering, with an MIST team ranking among the top finalists. The club even runs its own dedicated CTF platform. This platform was developed by current president Iftee Khar-UI-Islam and it gives members a space to practise year-round.

Achievements along the way:

After LeetCon, MIST students started showing up consistently in national CTFs. In FlagHunt 2023, multiple MIST teams advanced to the finals, with 403_f0rbidden securing a strong finish. Later that year, MIST_Hamsters and CR4CK_P3G4SUS reached the finals of BUET's national CTF, ranking among the top 30 out of more than 120 teams. Other teams performed impressively at SUST SWE Technovent 2023, finishing in the top 25.

The streak continued in 2024. Muntasir Hasan Porag (lee69) secured 14th place in Phoenix Summit CTF. Teams like Hacker_Vab_Skill_r_Ovab and B00G3YM3N showed great results at BUET CTF 2024, ranking in the national top tier. At EWU NRF CTF 2024, MIST teams finished in the top 10, with B00G3YM3N grabbing 5th place.

By 2025, the club was hosting and co-hosting events of its own scale. In January, MIST hosted Cyber Raid 2025, in partnership with the IT Directorate of Bangladesh Army and Kerberos, with a massive prize pool and expert talks. Soon after, MIST held CyberTron 2025, an intra-MIST CTF on its own platform, complete with guest lectures and farewells to the outgoing presidential panel.

And in May 2025, MIST co-hosted the World Telecommunication and Information Society Day Hackathon. Out of 176+ teams, the top 35 fought onsite at MIST, and the home team MIST_Shaheed_Yamin_Forever earned 5th place with a cash prize of Tk 50,000.

From 2023 to 2025, whether competing at BUET, SUST, UAP, or hosting their own, MIST teams became known across the country as strong contenders and skilled defenders.

The current phase:

MCSC is in an active and successful phase. In May 2025, the club co-hosted a national hackathon at MIST for World Telecommunication and Information Society Day. 190 teams joined online, and 35 reached the onsite finals. They competed in cryptography, web, forensics, networking, steganography, and reverse engineering. A MIST team ranked high among the finalists.

MIST teams also performed well in inter-university CTFs, placing in BUET's finals and holding a steady spot among strong national teams. Since LeetCon 2023, MIST has become a known hub for cybersecurity talent.

Training is a big focus. The MIST Cyber Range under CACR offers hands-on labs and short courses. The club runs separate batches for beginners, intermediate, and advanced students. With events, training, and results, MCSC keeps raising the bar for student defenders in Bangladesh. Last year, Ethical Hacking Course with Cyber Bangla was hosted. Again, currently our advanced batch is collaborating with Team Federal Bonk Investigations to increase their expertise and skills

Quotes:

Dr. Md. Mahbubur Rahman, one of the club's moderators, says, "I want students to take up this career more and more. I want them to build the confidence inside them that all of them are capable of securing in cyber space."

Co-moderator Lt Col Md Abul Basar, psc, Signals, adds, "Cybersecurity isn't just about technology; it's about using curiosity, creativity and skill to protect data and other valuable assets from constantly changing threats."

Easin Arafat, the second president of the club stresses the urgency of the cause: "Cyber threats are a global concern, and Bangladesh is no exception. If we don't educate students about ransomware, phishing, malware and other attacks, our digital presence will never truly be secure."

His successor(3rd president), Shafee Shadman Tonoy, called for greater involvement beyond programming contests, saying, "While programming contests are highly regarded and looked forward to by students, we need equal or more participation in Capture the Flags (CTFs) and more cybersecurity advocacy and public engagement."

Former secretary Khaled Hasan Irfan, now serving as club coordinator, highlights the need for early engagement: "Bangladesh had been lagging behind in this field for quite some time now, as in CTF culture as well, but in recent times, we are seeing some good work and participation from Bangladeshi students. I am really hopeful about creating a community where all of us can learn from as well as impart our knowledge so that students don't have to step into this world

from their academic courses in their 4th year. Even a 1st or 2nd year student can become well equipped with this field's knowledge and start early."